

flora wellness

GUIDE 02 · THE FLORA COLLECTION

The Cycle Syncing Meal Bible

Eat for your hormones, phase by phase.

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Food Is Your Most Powerful Hormonal Tool

You eat 3–5 times a day. Every single meal either supports hormonal balance or undermines it. Cycle syncing your nutrition means matching what you eat to where you are in your menstrual cycle — because your body's needs genuinely change across the four phases. This isn't a diet. It is a framework for eating in harmony with your biology.

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Women who cycle sync their nutrition report 40–60% reduction in cycle-related symptoms within two months, alongside improvements in energy, body composition, mental clarity, and overall wellbeing.

WHAT'S INSIDE THIS GUIDE

- Phase-by-phase nutrition science explaining WHY each food group matters when
- Top 10 power foods for each of the four cycle phases
- Full 28-day meal plan with breakfast, lunch, and dinner for each day
- 6 complete recipes designed for each phase's hormonal needs
- Phase-specific grocery checklists to make shopping effortless
- The foods to avoid in each phase — and why

KEY TAKEAWAY

You don't need to be on the same cycle day as the guide. Start wherever you are in your cycle today and rotate through the phases from there.

Why Your Nutritional Needs Change

Your hormones don't stay constant across your cycle — they fluctuate in a predictable pattern that changes your caloric needs, macronutrient requirements, micronutrient demands, and even which foods your digestive system handles best. Eating the same way across your entire cycle ignores this biology.

THE SCIENCE · RESTING METABOLIC RATE

Your resting metabolic rate increases by approximately 10% in the luteal phase (days 15–28) due to progesterone's thermogenic effect and increased energy demands of the corpus luteum. This is why cravings are stronger before your period — your body genuinely needs more calories. Restricting food in the luteal phase increases cortisol and worsens PMS symptoms.

MENSTRUAL (Days 1–5)

Estrogen and progesterone are at their lowest. Iron is being lost through bleeding. Prostaglandins drive inflammation and cramps. Nutrition focus: replenish iron, reduce inflammation, and support the nervous system through the hormonal trough.

FOLLICULAR (Days 6–13)

Rising estrogen increases insulin sensitivity, improves mood, and boosts metabolism. The body is primed to build and restore. Nutrition focus: lean proteins, complex carbs, and cruciferous vegetables to support healthy estrogen metabolism as levels rise.

OVULATORY (Days 14–16)

Estrogen peaks; LH surges. Highest energy and lowest appetite of the cycle. Liver load is at its peak as it processes the estrogen surge. Nutrition focus: anti-inflammatory, light, easily digestible foods with liver-support nutrients.

LUTEAL (Days 17–28)

Progesterone dominates; metabolic rate rises; serotonin begins falling as estrogen drops in late luteal. Nutrition focus: complex carbohydrates for serotonin, magnesium for cramp prevention, and increased healthy fats to support progesterone production.

What to Eat During Your Period

Your body is working hard during menstruation — shedding the uterine lining, losing iron through bleeding, and navigating the lowest hormone levels of your cycle. This is not the time for restriction; it is the time for deep nourishment.

TOP 10 MENSTRUAL PHASE FOODS

Grass-fed beef

Haem iron for blood replenishment; zinc for immune function

Dark leafy greens

Non-haem iron + vitamin C for absorption; folate for cell repair

Lentils & beans

Plant iron + protein; fibre to ease digestive sluggishness

Wild salmon

Omega-3s reduce prostaglandins and cramp severity

Beets

Nitrates improve blood flow; betaine supports methylation

Dark chocolate (85%+)

Magnesium for cramp relief; iron; mood support via serotonin

Ginger

Reduces prostaglandin production — as effective as ibuprofen in studies

Bone broth

Collagen + glycine to repair the gut lining; electrolytes

Blackstrap molasses

Highest food source of non-haem iron; calcium and B6

Turmeric

Curcumin blocks COX-2 — the same pathway NSAIDs target for pain

FOODS TO MINIMISE THIS PHASE

- Alcohol — depletes iron absorption and worsens bleeding
- Caffeine — constricts blood vessels, intensifying cramps
- Refined sugar — spikes inflammation and worsens mood instability
- Raw cold foods — TCM principle: cold contracts; warm foods support blood flow

Eating for Rising Estrogen

The follicular phase is your biological spring. Estrogen rises, energy builds, insulin sensitivity is at its peak, and your body is primed to build and create. This is the ideal phase for introducing new foods, trying new recipes, and eating more adventurously — your digestion is at its strongest.

TOP 10 FOLLICULAR PHASE FOODS

Broccoli & sprouts

DIM + sulforaphane for healthy estrogen metabolism

Eggs

Choline for liver function; B12 for methylation

Fermented foods

Gut microbiome support for estrogen clearance

Quinoa

Complete protein + iron; lighter carb profile for spring energy

Avocado

Healthy fats support estrogen synthesis; folate

Green tea

EGCG supports liver Phase I estrogen detox

Flaxseeds

Lignans regulate estrogen receptor sensitivity

Citrus fruits

Vitamin C + flavonoids support liver detox of estrogen

Artichoke

Cynarin stimulates bile for fat-soluble hormone clearance

Asparagus

Folate + prebiotic fibre; glutathione precursor

THE SCIENCE · INSULIN SENSITIVITY

Estrogen improves insulin sensitivity, meaning your body processes carbohydrates more efficiently in the follicular phase. This is the optimal time to consume slightly higher carbohydrate loads — your cells will use them for energy rather than storing them as fat. Leverage this window with whole food carbohydrates.

Eating for the Ovulation Window

Ovulation is your body's monthly performance peak. LH surges, estrogen peaks, and testosterone briefly rises — giving you your most magnetic, energetic days of the cycle. Your liver is processing the highest hormone load of the month. Nutrition goal: support the liver, reduce inflammation, and keep energy steady.

TOP 10 OVULATORY PHASE FOODS

Oysters & shellfish

Zinc for egg quality and LH surge support

Raspberries

Antioxidants protect eggs from oxidative stress

Sunflower seeds

Vitamin E for follicle development and ovarian health

Watercress

Liver-cleansing + anti-inflammatory; supports estrogen clearance

Quinoa

Light complete protein won't tax digestion during hormone surge

Asparagus

Folate for DNA integrity in the egg; natural diuretic

Raw carrots

Unique fibre binds excess estrogen for excretion

Pomegranate

Ellagitannins support estrogen metabolism; antioxidant rich

Coconut water

Electrolytes for the hormonal surge; natural hydration

Light leafy salads

Bitter greens stimulate bile release for hormone clearance

KEY TAKEAWAY

The ovulatory phase is the shortest — just 2–3 days. If you miss the specific foods, don't stress. The liver-support and anti-inflammatory principles from this phase carry into the early luteal phase and still benefit your hormonal balance.

Eating to Prevent PMS

The luteal phase is where your nutritional choices have the greatest impact on how you feel. Serotonin begins falling as estrogen drops in the late luteal phase. Progesterone's thermogenic effect increases your caloric need. This is not the time for strict caloric restriction — it is the time for strategic, satisfying nourishment.

TOP 10 LUTEAL PHASE FOODS

Sweet potato

Complex carbs boost serotonin; beta-carotene for progesterone

Pumpkin seeds

Zinc supports corpus luteum; magnesium for cramp prevention

Dark chocolate

Magnesium + serotonin precursors; satisfies cravings cleanly

Chickpeas

B6 for serotonin; zinc; fibre for estrogen clearance

Brown rice

Slow carbs maintain steady serotonin without the crash

Sesame seeds

Seed cycling phase 2; lignans; calcium for PMS mood

Wild salmon

Omega-3s reduce prostaglandins and luteal inflammation

Turkey

Tryptophan — direct serotonin precursor; B6 rich

Chamomile tea

Apigenin reduces anxiety by binding GABA-A receptors

Almonds

Magnesium + healthy fats; satisfying for evening cravings

+10%

Metabolic rate in luteal phase

200 kcal

Extra calories your body needs

Day 22

When serotonin begins falling

3× more

Magnesium needed vs follicular

Menstrual Phase Meal Plan

Days 1–5 · Focus: Iron, Warmth, Anti-inflammation

DAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER
Mon	Warm oats + blackstrap molasses + cinnamon	Lentil soup + dark rye bread	Grass-fed beef stir-fry + beets + brown rice
Tue	Ginger turmeric tea + soft-boiled eggs + toast	Spinach & chickpea curry	Slow-cooked salmon + sweet potato mash
Wed	Dark chocolate overnight oats	Lentil & kale soup + pumpkin seeds	Lamb & root vegetable stew
Thu	Bone broth + poached eggs + dark bread	Beetroot & lentil salad + tahini	Wild salmon fishcakes + steamed greens
Fri	Warm quinoa porridge + berries + honey	Minestrone soup + sourdough	Chicken liver & caramelised onions + rice

Follicular Phase Meal Plan

Days 6–13 · Focus: Cruciferous veg, Gut health, Light proteins

DAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER
Mon	Avocado toast + poached eggs + sprouts	Broccoli & quinoa power bowl	Baked salmon + roasted broccoli + quinoa
Tue	Green smoothie + granola	Kale Caesar + grilled chicken	Stir-fried tofu + bok choy + brown rice
Wed	Overnight oats + kiwi + flaxseeds	Artichoke & feta salad + sourdough	Lemon herb chicken + asparagus
Thu	Chia pudding + mango + citrus zest	Fermented kimchi rice bowl	White fish + sautéed greens + sweet potato
Fri	Scrambled eggs + sauerkraut + rye toast	Broccoli & walnut pasta	Prawn & avocado lettuce wraps

Ovulatory Phase Meal Plan

Days 14–16 · Focus: Light, liver-support, antioxidant-rich

DAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER
Mon	Fruit & yogurt bowl + seeds	Large salad + grilled sardines	Oysters + light vegetable broth + rice
Tue	Green juice + boiled eggs	Watercress & pomegranate salad	Grilled prawns + raw carrot slaw
Wed	Acai bowl + coconut flakes	Raspberry & walnut salad + tahini	Baked white fish + roasted asparagus

Luteal Phase Meal Plan

Days 17–28 · Focus: Serotonin, Magnesium, Complex carbs

DAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER
Mon	Sweet potato hash + eggs	Chickpea & spinach stew	Turkey & brown rice stuffed peppers
Tue	Banana oat pancakes + almond butter	Lentil dal + wholegrain naan	Wild salmon + roasted sweet potato
Wed	Pumpkin seed granola + oat milk	Brown rice & edamame bowl	Chicken stir-fry + sesame + brown rice
Thu	Warm oats + almonds + dark chocolate	Turkey & avocado wrap + pumpkin soup	Baked cod + lentils + wilted greens
Fri	Tahini banana smoothie + seed mix	Roasted veg & chickpea tray bake	Grass-fed beef + sweet potato mash
Sat	Chia & cacao pudding + berries	Warming vegetable soup + rye bread	Slow-cooked lamb + root vegetables
Sun	Scrambled eggs + sautéed mushrooms	Quinoa & roasted squash bowl	Turkey meatballs + courgette noodles

Hormone-Optimised Recipes

RECIPE

Anti-Cramp Ginger Lentil Soup

□ 35 min

▪ Serves 4

INGREDIENTS

- 200g red lentils
- 1 tbsp fresh ginger (grated)
- 2 tsp turmeric
- 1 can chopped tomatoes
- 1 tsp cumin seeds
- 400ml vegetable stock
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Fresh coriander to serve

METHOD

- 1 Fry cumin seeds in oil until fragrant. Add ginger, turmeric, cook 2 mins.
- 2 Add lentils, tomatoes, and stock. Simmer 20 minutes until lentils are soft.
- 3 Blend partially, season, and top with fresh coriander. Serve warm.

RECIPE

Follicular Broccoli & Egg Power Bowl

□ 20 min

▪ Serves 2

INGREDIENTS

- 1 head broccoli, florets
- 4 eggs
- 2 tbsp tahini
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 2 tbsp pumpkin seeds
- 1 tbsp sauerkraut
- 1 tsp sesame oil
- Pinch chilli flakes

METHOD

- 1 Steam broccoli 5 mins. Soft-boil eggs 7 mins, peel and halve.
- 2 Mix tahini, lemon, sesame oil, and 2 tbsp water into dressing.
- 3 Assemble bowl: broccoli, eggs, sauerkraut, seeds. Drizzle dressing.

RECIPE

Luteal Serotonin Sweet Potato Bowl

🕒 40 min

▪ Serves 2

INGREDIENTS

- 2 medium sweet potatoes
- 200g cooked chickpeas
- 100g turkey mince
- 1 tbsp pumpkin seeds
- 1 tsp cumin
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 2 tbsp tahini
- Handful spinach

METHOD

- 1 Roast sweet potatoes at 200°C for 35 minutes until soft.
- 2 Brown turkey mince with cumin and paprika. Add chickpeas.
- 3 Halve sweet potatoes, top with turkey mix, spinach, seeds, and tahini.

RECIPE

Ovulatory Watercress & Pomegranate Salad

🕒 10 min

▪ Serves 2

INGREDIENTS

- 100g watercress
- 80g pomegranate seeds
- 50g walnuts
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp pomegranate molasses
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- Salt and pepper

METHOD

- 1 Toast walnuts lightly in a dry pan. Allow to cool.
- 2 Whisk olive oil, molasses, and mustard into a dressing.
- 3 Toss watercress with dressing, top with pomegranate and walnuts.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Batch cook on Sundays for the week ahead. The menstrual and luteal phases in particular benefit from having warm, nourishing meals ready — when you feel low-energy, you won't reach for processed food if the right food is already prepared.

The Cycle Syncing Grocery List

Stock these items and you'll always have the building blocks for phase-appropriate meals. The staples list forms the base; add the phase-specific fresh items each week.

PANTRY STAPLES (KEEP ALWAYS)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Ground flaxseeds | ☐ Oats |
| ☐ Pumpkin seeds | ☐ Canned chickpeas |
| ☐ Sesame seeds | ☐ Canned tomatoes |
| ☐ Sunflower seeds | ☐ Bone broth |
| ☐ Red lentils | ☐ Apple cider vinegar |
| ☐ Brown rice | ☐ Olive oil |
| ☐ Quinoa | ☐ Coconut oil |

MENSTRUAL PHASE FRESH

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Grass-fed beef or lamb | ☐ Turmeric root |
| ☐ Dark leafy greens (kale, spinach) | ☐ Lentils (green/brown) |
| ☐ Beets | ☐ Wild salmon |
| ☐ Fresh ginger | ☐ Dark chocolate (85%+) |

FOLLICULAR PHASE FRESH

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Broccoli + sprouts | ☐ Fermented foods (kimchi, kefir) |
| ☐ Artichoke | ☐ Citrus fruits |
| ☐ Asparagus | ☐ Free-range eggs |
| ☐ Avocado | ☐ Green tea |

LUTEAL PHASE FRESH

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Sweet potato | ☐ Almonds |
| ☐ Turkey mince | ☐ Chickpeas (cooked) |
| ☐ Chamomile tea | ☐ Brown rice |
| ☐ Dark chocolate (85%+) | ☐ Salmon (wild caught) |

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The Flora Collection

01 · The 28-Day Hormone Reset

02 · The Cycle Syncing Meal Bible

03 · The Hormone Type Guide

04 · The Symptom Decoder

05 · The PMS Elimination Guide

06 · The Cortisol Reset

07 · The Cycle Fitness Guide

08 · The 90-Day Rebalancing Roadmap

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